

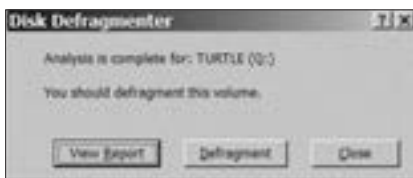
the disk looks like before defragmentation, and the second one tells you what it'll look like after.

When you start the defragger, first analyse the drive(s) by right-clicking on each drive. After analysing the drive, you'll get an advice box as shown below, which tells you whether you need to defrag the drive or not.



XP's defragger looks very different from 98's

In most cases, you should accept Windows' advice. You can start the defragmenting process by clicking the 'Defragment' button. Remember that a drive



XP tells you whether or not you need to defrag

needs to have 15 per cent of free space for the defragging process to continue normally—Windows uses this free space as a scratch-pad. If there's less than 15 per cent of free space and you choose to defragment the drive anyway, the defragmenting process will not yield the best results.

You cannot defragment volumes the file system has marked as "dirty", which indicates possible corruption. You must run the chkdsk program (more on this later) on a dirty volume before you can defragment it. You can determine if a volume is dirty by using the "fsutil dirty query" command—for example, "fsutil dirty query c:." will tell you if the c: drive is dirty.

Then there are the 'Pause', 'Stop' and 'Resume' buttons to be talked about. You should use the 'Pause' and 'Resume' buttons from time to time if the defragging process is taking too long, so